would henceforth contest ‘each election’ in UP, he also started a new OBC outreach. He saw it as part of an effort to focus on communities that had not been supporting the BJP so far, what he called the hitherto ‘dark zone’ of the state of BJP.[17]

Figure 3.3: Caste Composition of BJP, SP, BSP, INC Vidhan Sabha Candidates, UP, 2017